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J. Srinivas, *Future of the BRICS and the Role of Russia and China*
https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-19-1115-6_1

1. Introduction and Conceptual Framework

Junuguru Srinivas[1] ✉
(1) Political Science, School of Liberal Arts and Humanities, Woxsen University, Hyderabad, Telangana, India

✉ **Junuguru Srinivas**
Email: sreenujnu@gmail.com

Keywords BRICS – Global south – Global order – International relations

Introduction

Over the last three decades, the global economy has been transformed with several countries like Brazil, India, China, Indonesia, Mexico, and South Africa in the post-globalization era. Countries in the European Union (EU) have faced stagnation and recession, while several southern countries have shown high growth and economic development levels. Russia leveraged its oil sales and export of weapons to induce its transition following the Soviet disintegration of 1991. The fast-growing economies of China, India, and Brazil have stood out and have accelerated their growth. This trend catalyzed several changes within the international system. Following the end of the Cold War[1] between the USSR (Union of Soviet Socialist Republics) and America in the mid-twentieth century, the United States of America (USA) emerged as a dominating player in international politics. It faced political resistance from Russia and China, who sought to construct a new economic structure of several global powers. It has resulted in what is termed as a ‘multipolar’[2] political and economic system, challenging the